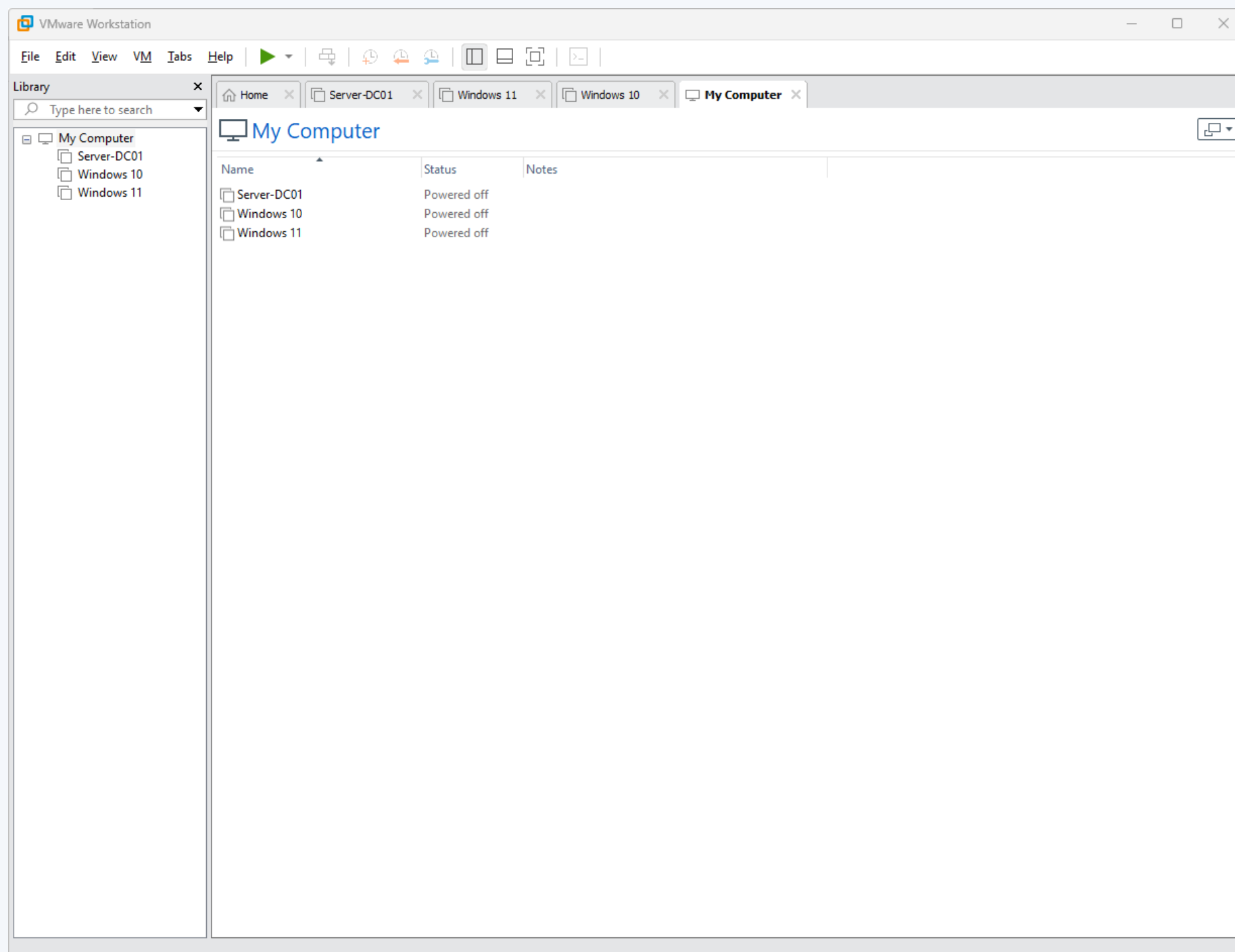


VMware Lab Environment

Before installing Windows Server, I prepared my virtual lab environment in VMware Workstation.

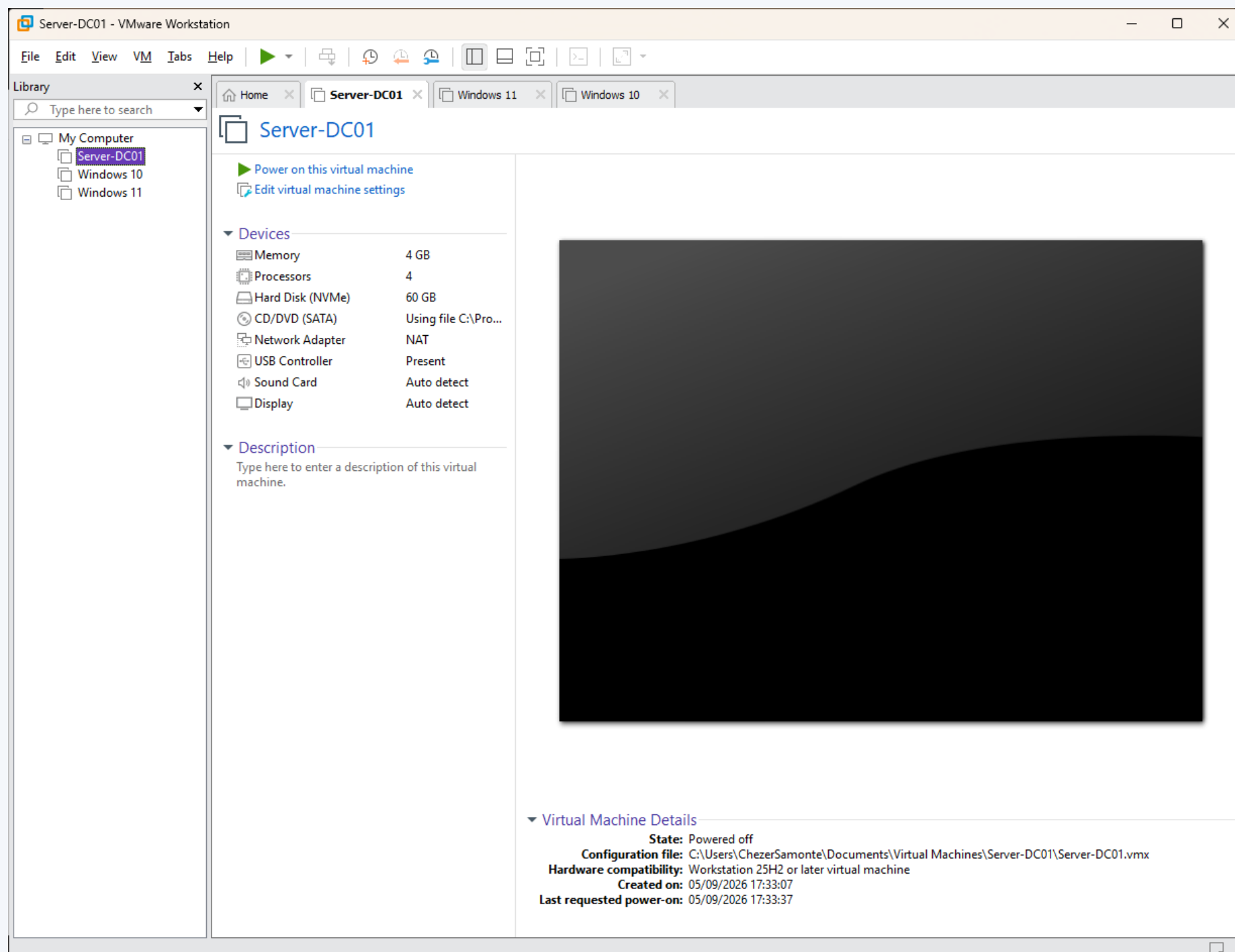


- Windows Server 2022
- Windows 10 Client
- Windows 11 Client
- Virtual network connecting the machines

This lab will allow me to practice Windows Server administration in a controlled environment.

Windows Server 2022 VM Setup

I created a dedicated virtual machine for my Windows Server 2022 installation.

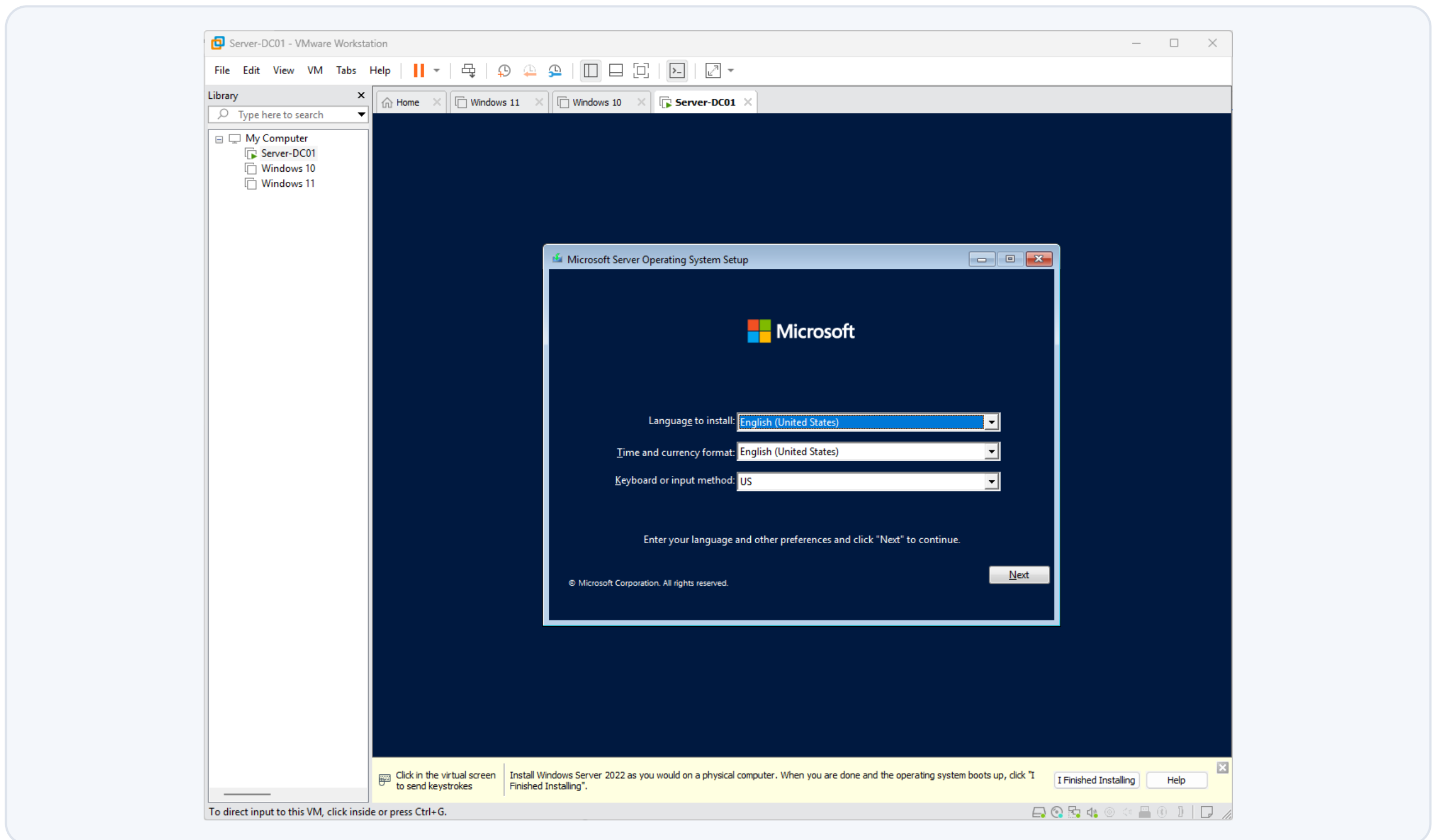


- Memory: 4 GB RAM
- Processor: 4 vCPU
- Storage: 60 GB
- Network: Virtual Network
- Installation Media: Windows Server 2022 ISO

These resources provide enough capacity for my Windows Server learning lab.

Windows Server Setup

With the virtual machine ready, I booted it using the Windows Server 2022 ISO.

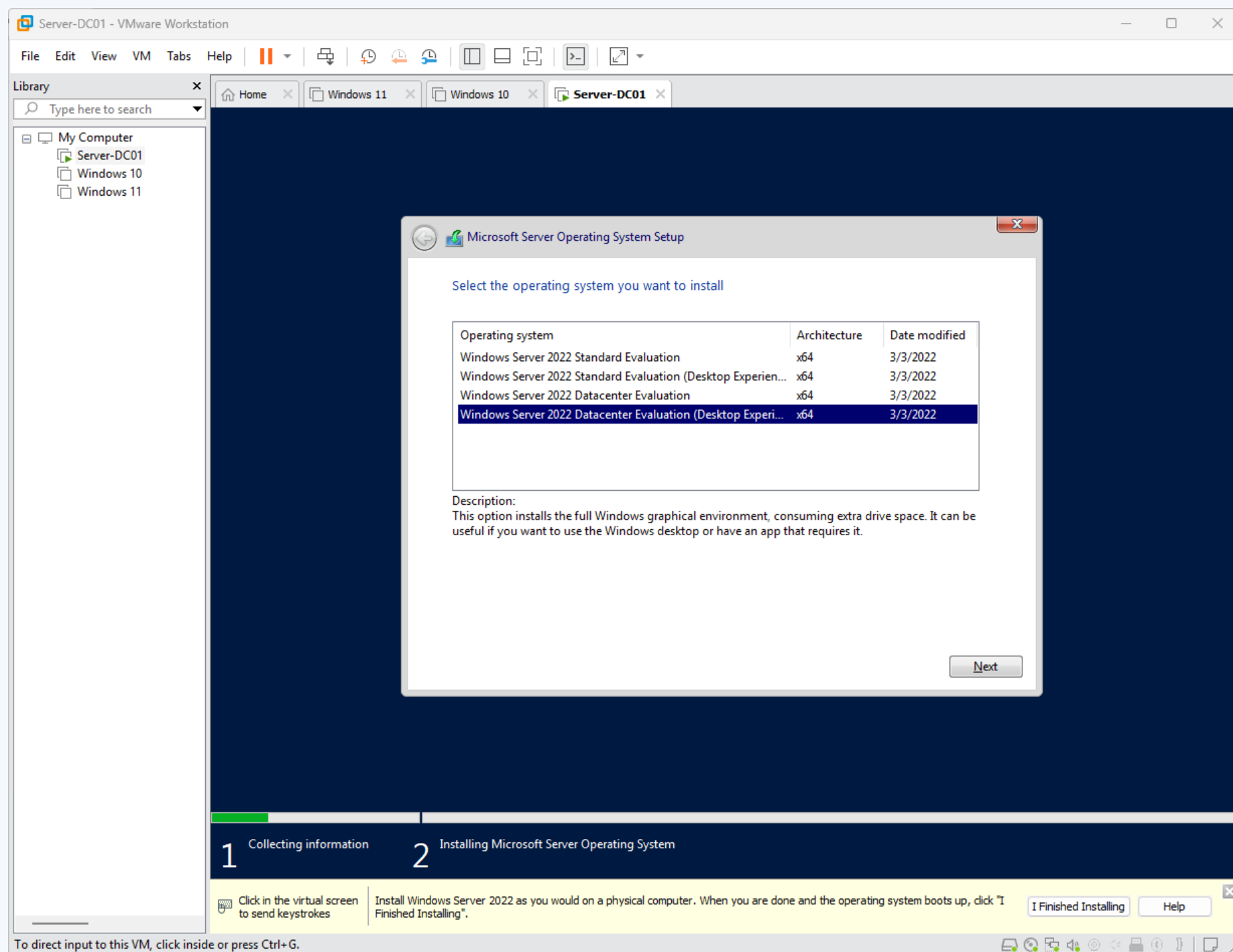


- Boot from the ISO
- Select language and keyboard settings
- Click Install Now
- Continue to Windows Server Setup

The installation process begins from here.

Selecting the Server Edition

For this lab, I selected Windows Server 2022 Datacenter (Desktop Experience).

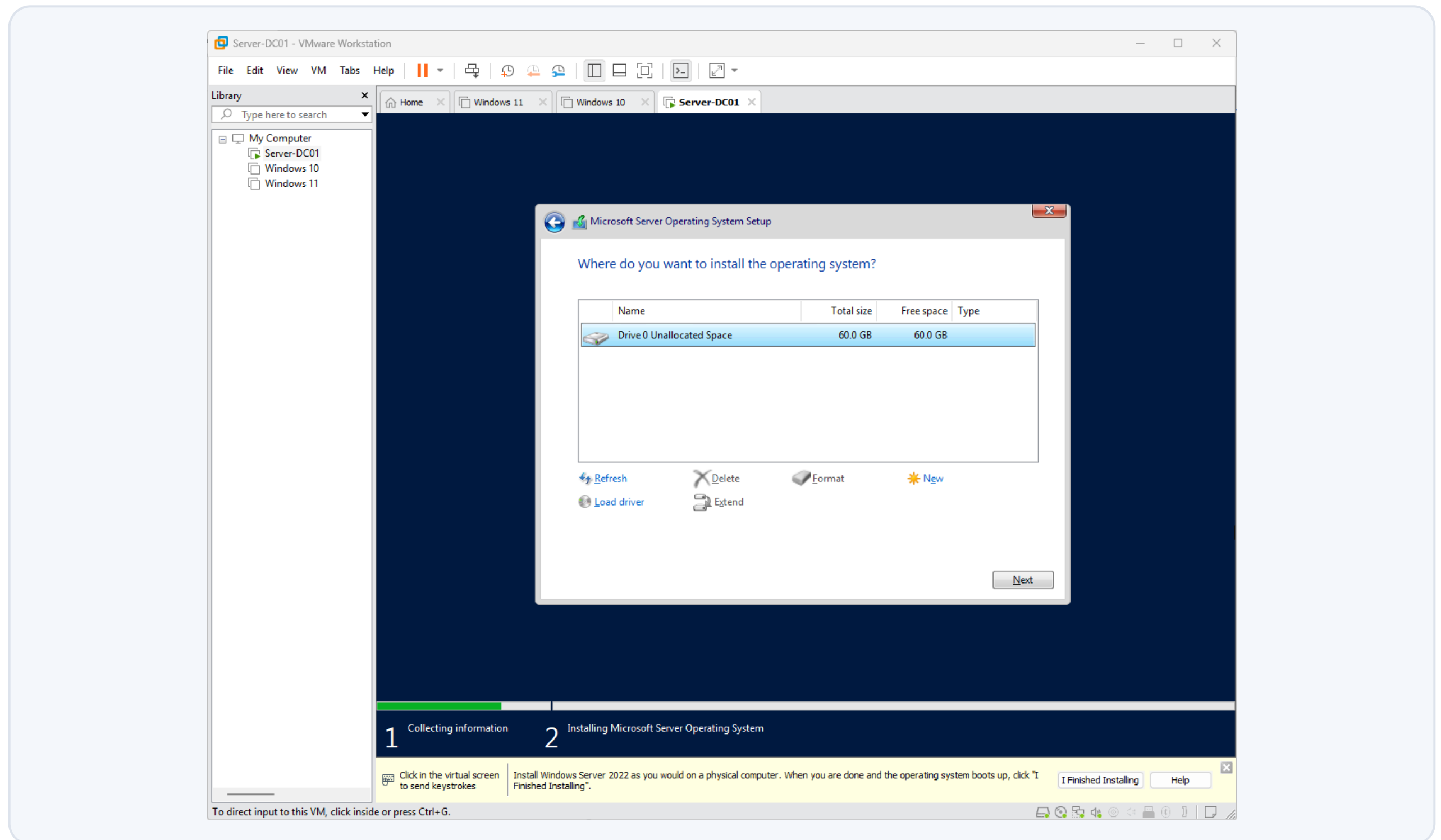


- Windows Server 2022 Datacenter
- Desktop Experience

I chose Desktop Experience because it provides a graphical interface that makes it easier to learn and manage Windows Server during my hands-on lab exercises.

Disk Configuration

Next, I selected the virtual disk created for the server.

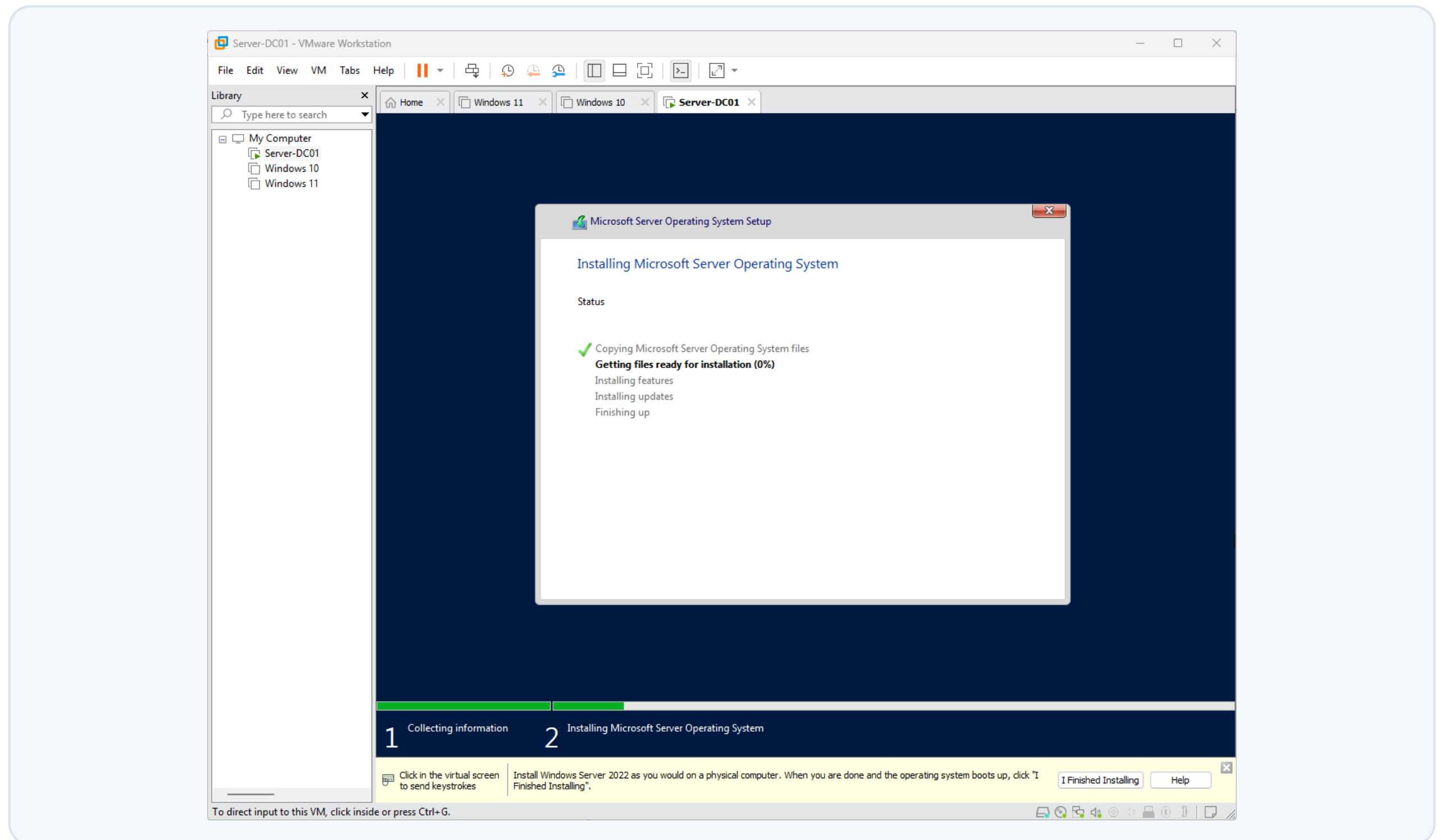


- Select the target disk
- Configure the installation location
- Start the Windows Server installation
- Allow Windows Setup to copy and install the required files

The virtual machine is now being prepared with Windows Server 2022.

Windows Server Installation

Windows Setup is now installing the operating system.

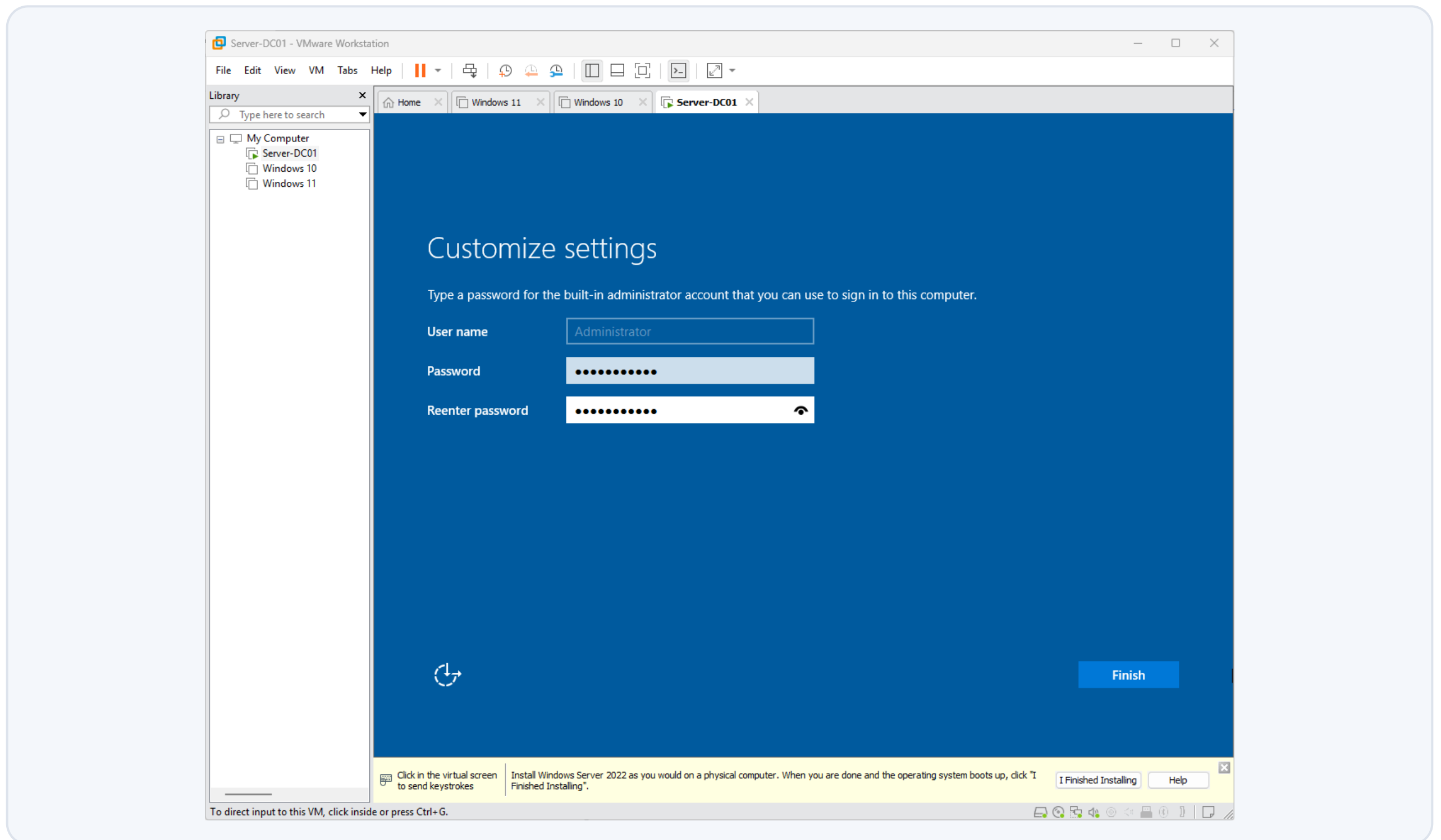


- Copies installation files
- Installs Windows components
- Applies the selected configuration
- Prepares the system for the first boot

After the installation finishes, the server will restart automatically.

Administrator Account

After Windows Server installation, I configured the local Administrator account.

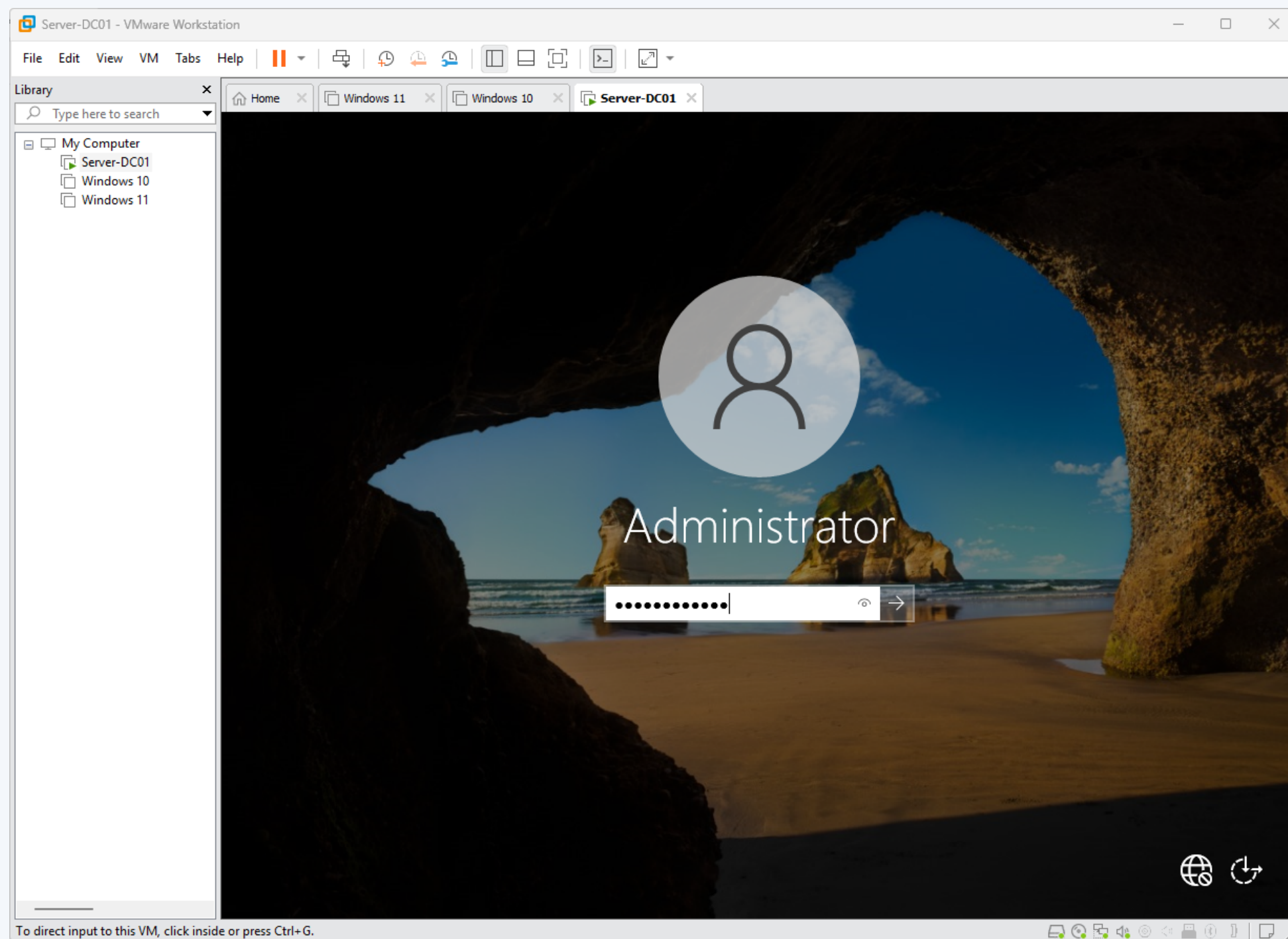


- Create Administrator password
- Confirm password
- Complete the initial setup

This account will be used to perform administrative tasks in the lab.

First Login to Windows Server

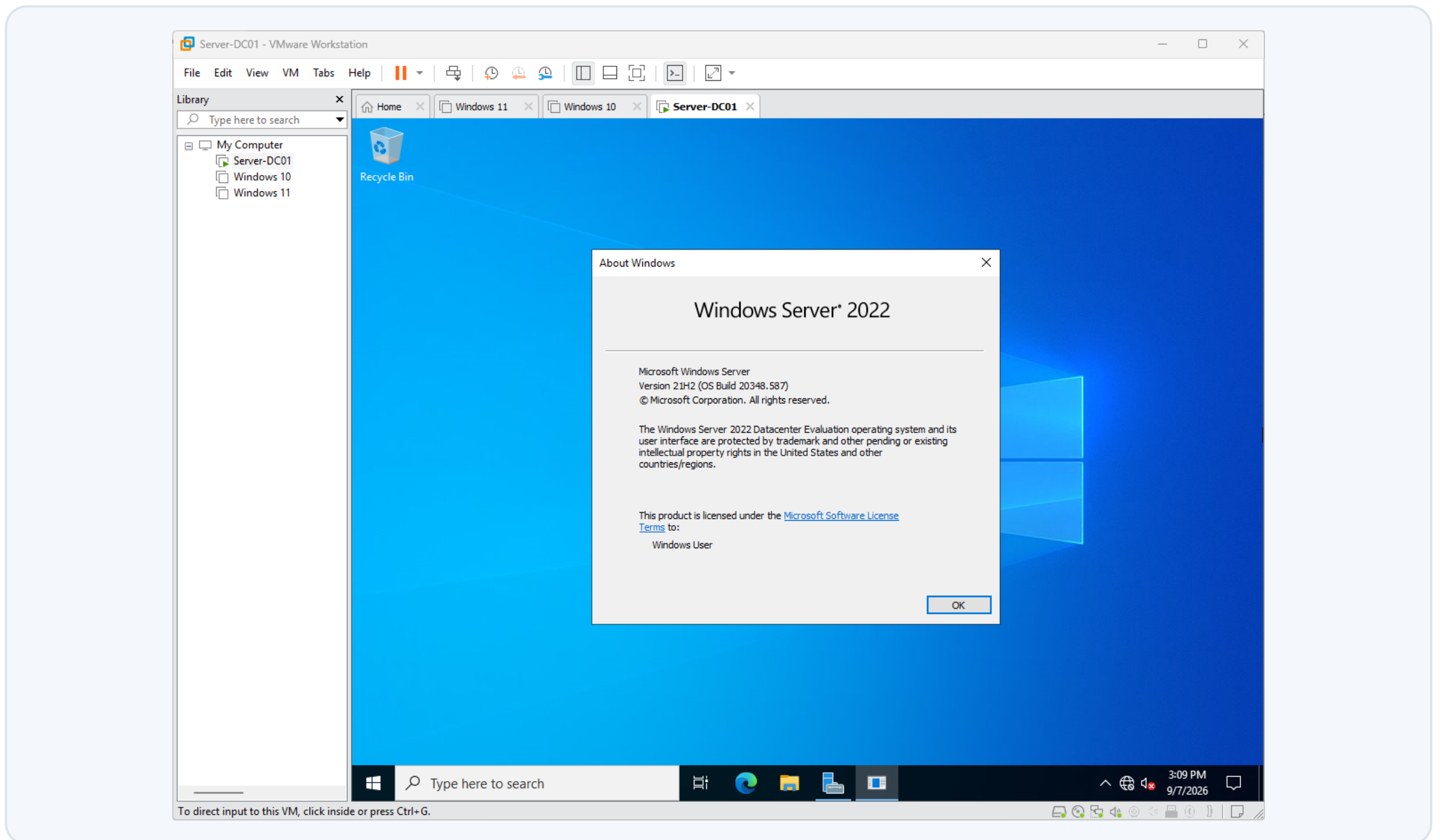
The installation is complete. I logged in using the local Administrator account and confirmed that the Windows Server desktop loaded successfully.



Windows Server 2022 is now up and running — the foundation of the lab is ready for the next stage.

Installation Verification

Before moving forward, I verified that the server was installed successfully.



- ✓ Windows Server 2022 installed
- ✓ Administrator account working
- ✓ CPU and RAM recognized
- ✓ Storage recognized
- ✓ Network adapter detected
- ✓ Server boots normally

Installation complete.